

The background of the journal cover is a vibrant landscape photograph. It depicts a small village with several houses, including a prominent two-story white house with a red roof, situated on a lush green hillside. A clear blue river flows through the foreground, surrounded by dense green vegetation. In the background, dark, forested mountains rise under a bright blue sky with scattered white clouds. The overall scene is peaceful and scenic.

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संपादकीय

संसार एक रंगमंच है, जहाँ पर पुरुष और स्त्री दोनों को ही अभिनय करना पड़ता है। देश के निर्माण में पुरुषों के साथ महिलाओं का भी महत्वपूर्ण योगदान रहा है। मानव जीवन का प्रारम्भ ही महिला की गोद में होता है। भारतीय समाज में नारियों की पूजा विभिन्न रूपों में होती रही है। प्राचीन भारतीय इतिहास के पृष्ठ भारतीय महिलाओं की गौरव-गाथा से भरे पड़े हैं। अतितकाल में नारियों को पुरुषों के समान अधिकार प्राप्त थे, परिवार में उनका स्थान प्रतिष्ठापूर्ण था, गृहस्थी का कोई भी कार्य उनकी सहमति के बिना नहीं होता था। इतिहास इस बात का गवाह है कि जब रामचन्द्र जी ने अश्वमेध यज्ञ किया तो उन्होंने सीताजी के वनवास के कारण उनकी स्वर्ण प्रतिमा रखकर यज्ञ की पूर्ति की थी। आवश्यकता पड़ने पर स्त्रियाँ पुरुषों के साथ रणक्षेत्र में भी जाती थी। देवासुर संग्राम की उस घटना को कौन भूल सकता है, जिसमें कैकयी ने अपने अद्वितीय कौशल से महाराजा दशरथ को भी विस्मित कर दिया था। प्राचीन काल में नारियों को अपनी योग्यता के अनुसार पति चुनने का अधिकार था। शकुन्तला, सीता, अनसूइया, दमयन्ती, सावित्री आदि प्रमुख स्त्रियाँ इसके प्रमुख उदाहरण हैं।

किसी भी देश के विकास के अध्ययन में तत्कालीन समाज में स्त्रियों की स्थिति से पर्याप्त प्रकाश पड़ता है। भारत इसका अपवाद नहीं है। पितृसत्तात्मक समाज में प्राचीन काल से ही पुत्र का पुत्री की अपेक्षा अधिक महत्व था। आज जहाँ हम महिला सशक्तिकरण के अनेको दावे करते हैं लेकिन फिर भी महिलाओं को आज के भारतीय समाज में वह स्थान नहीं मिल पा रहा है जिसकी वह वास्तविक हकदार हैं। चूँकि भारतीय समाज में पितृसत्तात्मक व्यवस्था होने के कारण से उन्हें दायम दर्जे पर ही रखने की कोशिश की जाती है, फिर भी महिलाएँ अपने प्रयासों से ऊँचाई की बुलन्दियों को चूम रही हैं। आज हमारे देश में राष्ट्रपति से लेकर लोकसभा अध्यक्ष, सत्ता दल की कमान, विपक्ष की भूमिका में, प्रदेश के राज्यपाल, मुख्यमंत्री, प्रशासनिक और गैर प्रशासनिक पदों को महिलाएँ सुशोभित कर रही हैं। भारत जैसे विशाल जनसंख्या वाले देश की आधी जनसंख्या किसी भी मामले में पुरुषों से पीछे नहीं है, इसके बावजूद भी महिलाओं के साथ सौतेला व्यवहार किया जाता है। इन सबके बावजूद महिलाओं का सम्मानजनक स्थान सुनिश्चित करने के लिए अभी बहुत कुछ करना शेष है। आज नकारात्मक सोच और टिप्पणियों से ऊपर उठकर एक सकारात्मक वातावरण और और सोच विकसित करने की आवश्यकता है। समाज की एक ऐसी वाटिका विकसित करनी है, जिसमें बेटियाँ व तदन्तर महिलाएँ पुष्पित, पल्लवित, फलित व शोभित हों तभी हमारे समाज की सार्थकता होगी।

प्रधान—संपादक

शोधपत्रों के लेखन की समस्या

शोधपत्रों के लेखन में भी वे ही समस्या उत्पन्न होती है जो कि एक शोध में होती है। यहाँ यह बताना या चर्चा करना आवश्यक है कि एक शोधपत्र में वे ही टूल्स एवं टेक्निक का प्रयोग किया जायेगा जो कि एक शोध करने में किये जाते हैं। अतः हमें शोध के हर क्षेत्र का ज्ञान अवश्य होना चाहिए। तथा जिस विषय में शोध-पत्र लेखन का कार्य किया जा रहा है उसका समुचित अध्ययन किया जाना भी आवश्यक है साथ ही साथ आँकड़े, तथ्यों या एम्पेरिकल रिसर्च से प्राप्त आँकड़ों का विश्लेषण करना भी आवश्यक होता है। शोधपत्र लेखन की कुछ समस्या निम्नलिखित हैं—1.शोध समस्या का निर्धारण 2.प्राक्कल्पना का निर्माण 3.विषयवस्तु से संबंधित सामग्री की समस्या 4.विशिष्ट ज्ञान की आवश्यकता की समस्या 5.विभिन्न आँकड़ों को व्यवस्थित करने की समस्या 6.मूल्यांकन की समस्या।

उक्त समस्या का निस्तारण एक शोध के ज्ञान से हो सकता है जैसे—

1. विषय की जानकारी अच्छी हो। साथ ही हर एक शोधार्थियों को यह जान लेना चाहिए कि जिस भाषा में उसकी पकड़ है वह उसी में शोध करे तो सुविधा होती है तथा स्वयं की भाषा में शोध करने से तथ्य प्राप्त करने में सुविधा के साथ-साथ यह नियम एक सर्वमान्य नियम है कि शोधार्थी जिस भाषा को जानता है वह उसी में शोध करे।
2. प्राक्कल्पना का निर्माण करते समय शोध के उद्देश्यों का ध्यान रखा जाना चाहिए।
3. प्राक्कल्पना एवं उद्देश्य को ध्यान में रखते हुए चैप्टर तैयार करना चाहिए।
4. अंतिम चैप्टर में निष्कर्ष, प्राक्कल्पना के सिद्ध करने एवं शोध के द्वारा प्राप्त निष्कर्ष के मूल्यांकन से उत्पन्न स्थिति का जायजा लेने के बाद अपना सुझाव देना होता है।
5. शोध में अंतिम अवस्था शोध संदर्भ की होती है कि कौन-कौन से तथ्य कहाँ से प्राप्त किये गये थे। परंतु स्वयं कि सटिक शैली या मौलिकता के लिए संदर्भ आवश्यक नहीं है।

इस प्रकार से एक शोध का निर्माण किया जा सकता है तथा साथ ही विधि में भी किसी समस्या का हल किया जा सकता है। यथास्थान पूर्वनिर्णय, विधिक सिद्धांतों, रूढ़ि, प्रथाओं, न्यायाधीशों के मत, विधि की औचित्यता आदि को समाहित करना होता है। साथ ही साथ इसके सन्दर्भ नोट समाहित करना होता है। उक्त सभी के लिए हमें शोध को समझना आवश्यक होगा तथा उसकी प्रवृत्ति, अर्थ, परिभाषा, विशेषताएँ, उद्देश्य, शोध क्षेत्र, उसका विकास जानना आवश्यक होगा।

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CSR Communication as a tool for Public Awareness: A study of Corporate Practices in Raipur, Chhattisgarh

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Abstract

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has evolved into a crucial mechanism for businesses to engage with society, extending beyond compliance with legal mandates to fostering long-term social and economic development. However, the effectiveness of CSR initiatives largely depends on how well they are communicated to the public. CSR communication serves as a bridge between corporate efforts and societal impact, ensuring that communities are aware of, engaged in, and benefitting from these initiatives. In Raipur, Chhattisgarh, a rapidly growing industrial hub, numerous companies across sectors such as steel, energy, and manufacturing actively participate in CSR programs. While these initiatives focus on education, healthcare, infrastructure, and environmental sustainability, many fail to achieve their full potential due to limited public awareness and ineffective communication strategies.

This study explores CSR communication as a tool for public awareness, analyzing corporate practices in Raipur to assess how companies communicate their CSR activities, the effectiveness of their outreach efforts, and the impact of CSR-driven communication on community engagement and stakeholder participation. Through qualitative and quantitative analysis, the research identifies challenges in CSR communication, including lack of transparency, inadequate media engagement, and limited stakeholder involvement. The findings suggest that strategic and transparent CSR communication enhances public awareness, improves corporate accountability, and fosters long-term social impact.

By examining corporate communication strategies and public awareness levels, this study provides valuable insights for business leaders, policymakers, and communication professionals seeking to optimize CSR outreach and ensure that social initiatives achieve meaningful and sustainable development.

Keywords: Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), Public Awareness, CSR Communication, Stakeholder Engagement, Corporate Accountability, Raipur, Chhattisgarh

Introduction

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) has evolved from being a voluntary initiative to a mandatory obligation for businesses in India, particularly after the enactment of the Companies Act, 2013, which requires companies meeting certain financial thresholds to allocate at least 2% of their net profits toward CSR activities. While CSR initiatives aim to address societal challenges such as education, healthcare, environmental sustainability, and infrastructure development, their success depends not only on corporate funding but also on effective communication and public awareness. Without proper communication, even the most impactful CSR efforts remain unnoticed, limiting their potential to engage communities, influence policy discourse, and foster long-term sustainable development.

In Raipur, the capital of Chhattisgarh, a significant number of companies across various industries—including steel, energy, cement, and manufacturing—have been actively involved in CSR initiatives. These corporate-driven programs focus on social welfare, infrastructure enhancement, and environmental protection. However, one of the key challenges faced by CSR programs in Raipur is the lack of structured communication mechanisms that effectively inform and engage the public. Many companies undertake large-scale CSR projects but fail to create adequate awareness among the beneficiaries, policymakers, and the general public. Without effective CSR communication, public engagement remains low, reducing the social and developmental impact of corporate interventions.

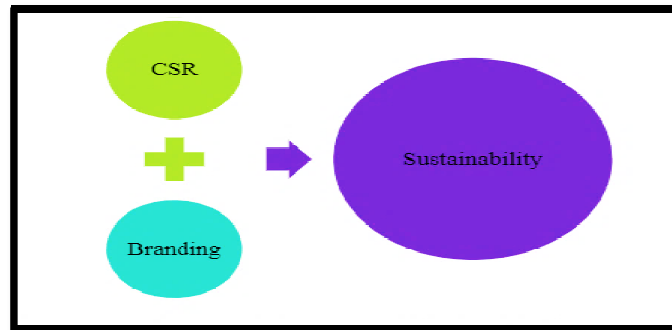
CSR communication serves as a strategic tool for public awareness, ensuring that corporate initiatives are not only executed but also understood, appreciated, and utilized by the communities they aim to support. When CSR initiatives are effectively communicated, they encourage greater participation, stakeholder

involvement, and transparency, thereby maximizing their social benefits. This study focuses on how companies in Raipur communicate their CSR initiatives, the effectiveness of their strategies in raising public awareness, and the extent to which CSR-driven communication influences community engagement, policy advocacy, and corporate accountability.

The growing industrial landscape of Raipur has led to the rise of various corporate-led social initiatives aimed at improving the quality of life for local communities. Despite significant investments in CSR, a major gap exists in how these initiatives are communicated and perceived by the public. In many cases, CSR programs operate in isolation from their intended beneficiaries, largely due to ineffective public outreach and communication strategies. This gap reduces the potential impact of CSR efforts, as public awareness plays a crucial role in encouraging community participation, stakeholder feedback, and policy-level support.

By examining CSR communication practices in Raipur, this study will provide insights into how companies can improve their outreach strategies to ensure that their CSR efforts are widely recognized, understood, and actively utilized by the people they aim to benefit. The research highlights the importance of transparent and strategic CSR communication in bridging the gap between corporate intentions and public expectations, ultimately contributing to the betterment of society.

CSR is not at all about administering public hospitals and schools. CSR is also not about sending support material to the trouble spots of the world. The contemporary world understands CSR much more intimately when you touch his life, with a little bit of CSR in your lather. CSR works at every stage. CSR is an all-encompassing process that embraces the betterment of society in a very inclusive manner. The terms “brand” and “sustainability” can be seen together more often today than ever before. Since brands are usually seen as the connector between business and people, their role has evolved beyond marketing to also represent corporate social responsibility (CSR) efforts. The relationship between CSR, Branding, and Sustainability can be interpreted as follows:



Figure¹

Literature Review

1. Introduction to CSR Communication and Public Awareness

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) communication has gained prominence as an essential aspect of corporate governance, enabling businesses to engage with stakeholders, inform communities, and enhance transparency in social initiatives. CSR is no longer limited to corporate philanthropy; instead, it has become a strategic tool for corporate accountability, stakeholder engagement, and policy advocacy. Effective CSR communication fosters public awareness, ensuring that beneficiaries understand and participate in corporate-led initiatives, thereby maximizing the social impact of CSR programs (Dawkins, 2004).

Despite mandatory CSR regulations under the Companies Act, 2013, research suggests that many CSR initiatives fail to reach their intended beneficiaries due to inadequate communication strategies (Kotler & Lee, 2005). In regions like Raipur, Chhattisgarh, where industrial activity plays a crucial role in

socio-economic development, CSR communication becomes even more critical in bridging the gap between corporate efforts and public awareness. This literature review explores existing studies on CSR communication and its role in enhancing public awareness, stakeholder engagement, and participatory governance in the context of corporate social initiatives.

2. The Role of CSR Communication in Enhancing Public Awareness

Public awareness is a critical determinant of CSR success, as it ensures that communities and stakeholders actively engage with corporate social initiatives. According to Manheim & Pratt (1986), CSR communication is a structured process through which businesses disseminate information about their social initiatives, ensuring that the public understands the objectives, benefits, and ways to engage. This process enhances corporate transparency and credibility, ultimately influencing stakeholder trust and public participation in CSR programs.

A study by Morsing & Schultz (2006) highlights that CSR communication should be two-way, allowing corporations to not only disseminate information but also receive feedback from communities. In regions like Raipur, where industries significantly impact local communities, CSR communication must focus on raising awareness about corporate interventions in areas such as healthcare, education, environmental conservation, and infrastructure development. The lack of public awareness often leads to underutilization or misunderstanding of CSR initiatives, reducing their overall effectiveness (Bhattacharya & Sen, 2004).

Several studies emphasize that CSR communication through digital platforms, community outreach programs, and mass media campaigns significantly improves public awareness. However, research also suggests that many companies fail to adopt comprehensive CSR communication strategies, limiting the reach and impact of their initiatives (Dawkins, 2004).

3. Strategies for Effective CSR Communication

Effective CSR communication involves clear messaging, multi-channel outreach, and engagement with local communities. Scholars suggest that corporations must adopt diverse communication methods, including:

1. Traditional Media (Print, Television, and Radio) – Research by Esrock & Leichty (1998) found that print and electronic media remain primary sources of information on CSR activities, especially in semi-urban and rural regions like Raipur.
2. Digital and Social Media – Studies by Capriotti & Moreno (2007) indicate that corporate websites, social media platforms, and online campaigns can effectively reach a wider audience, particularly the youth and urban stakeholders.
3. Community Engagement Programs – A study by Golob & Bartlett (2007) highlights that direct engagement with communities through workshops, awareness camps, and grassroots advocacy increases CSR visibility and ensures that beneficiaries actively participate in corporate-led initiatives.

In the case of Raipur, local industries need to incorporate localized communication strategies that align with the linguistic, cultural, and socio-economic dynamics of the region. Research suggests that many CSR communication strategies in industrial regions fail to consider the local context, resulting in low levels of public awareness and engagement (Chaudhri & Wang, 2007).

4. Challenges in CSR Communication and Public Awareness

Despite the growing recognition of CSR communication, several challenges hinder its effectiveness:

1. Lack of Structured Communication Plans – Many corporations do not integrate CSR communication into their overall business strategy, resulting in fragmented and inconsistent messaging (Dincer & Dincer, 2013).

2. Limited Public Engagement Mechanisms – Studies show that most CSR initiatives in industrial cities focus on execution rather than awareness-building, limiting public understanding of these initiatives (Coombs & Holladay, 2009).
3. Mistrust in Corporate Messaging – Public skepticism toward corporate motives can undermine CSR communication efforts. Consumers often perceive CSR initiatives as public relations stunts rather than genuine efforts for social change (Kim, Kim, & Cameron, 2009).
4. Low Accessibility to CSR Information – Research by Reeves & Ferguson-DeThorne (1980) suggests that corporate communication on CSR remains inaccessible to many stakeholders, particularly in lower-income and rural areas.

To overcome these challenges, CSR communication strategies must be tailored to local socio-economic conditions, ensuring that stakeholders receive accurate, relevant, and actionable information about CSR initiatives.

5. Case Studies on CSR Communication in Industrial Regions

Empirical studies indicate that CSR communication in industrial regions requires a targeted approach that aligns with regional development needs. For example:

1. Vedanta's Waste-to-Wealth Program in Chhattisgarh – Vedanta's CSR initiatives include local employment generation, environmental conservation, and health awareness programs, but limited outreach mechanisms reduce their overall public impact (Vedanta CSR Report, 2020).
2. Tata Steel's Educational CSR Initiatives – Tata Steel has implemented education-based CSR programs in Jharkhand and Odisha, but research indicates that lack of effective communication strategies limits community participation in these programs (Gopalkrishna, 1992).
3. Hindustan Unilever's Hygiene Awareness Campaigns – Before launching hygiene-related CSR programs, Hindustan Unilever conducted extensive public awareness campaigns in rural India, ensuring maximum beneficiary participation and social impact (Carroll, 1979).

For Raipur-based industries, adopting a similar approach by prioritizing community awareness, transparent CSR messaging, and participatory outreach programs can enhance the effectiveness of CSR initiatives in addressing regional development needs.

6. Research Gaps

The existing literature highlights the importance of CSR communication in enhancing public awareness, stakeholder engagement, and community participation. However, significant gaps remain in research specific to industrial cities like Raipur, where CSR efforts are extensive but poorly communicated. Key research gaps include:

1. Limited empirical studies on CSR communication effectiveness in Raipur.
2. Lack of assessment on how CSR communication influences public engagement in industrial regions.
3. Need for region-specific communication models for CSR outreach.

This study aims to fill these gaps by examining CSR communication practices in Raipur, identifying challenges, and proposing strategies to improve public awareness and participation.

Hypothesis

1. **H₁:** Effective CSR communication strategies have a significant positive impact on public awareness of corporate social responsibility initiatives in Raipur.
2. **H₂:** Higher levels of public awareness about CSR initiatives result in greater community participation in corporate-led social programs.
3. **H₃:** Increased CSR-related public awareness enhances corporate accountability, leading to better compliance with CSR commitments.

Expected Outcomes

1. A comprehensive documentation of CSR communication strategies in Raipur.
2. Insights into how companies use public hoardings and branding to communicate CSR.
3. Identification of patterns in CSR messaging, including common themes, promotional elements, and community engagement levels.
4. Recommendations for more effective, transparent, and meaningful CSR communication in industrial cities like Raipur.

Research Methodology**Research Design**

This study employs a qualitative research approach to analyze CSR communication strategies used by companies in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, focusing on how CSR initiatives are visually and publicly communicated through hoardings, infrastructure projects, branding elements, and public displays. The research aims to assess the effectiveness of these communication strategies in raising public awareness and stakeholder engagement regarding corporate social responsibility initiatives.

The study is descriptive and exploratory in nature, using visual content analysis and case study methodology to systematically document and interpret how CSR communication is presented in public spaces.

Research Objectives

1. To document and analyze CSR hoardings, public displays, and branding initiatives related to CSR in Raipur.
2. To examine the visual and textual elements used in CSR communication in public spaces.
3. To identify patterns, themes, and messaging strategies in CSR hoardings.
4. To assess how CSR communication is positioned in relation to corporate responsibility and public engagement.
5. To explore the effectiveness of CSR messaging in raising awareness and fostering public discourse.

Data Collection Methods

Since this research is purely qualitative and based on existing CSR communication materials, the primary method of data collection is visual documentation and analysis of CSR elements in Raipur's public spaces.

A. Primary Data: Visual Documentation

The study involves **photographic documentation and content analysis** of:

1. **CSR Hoardings and Billboards**
 - o Public-facing CSR messages on hoardings, banners, and digital screens.
 - o Example: CSR branding on infrastructure projects (e.g., Make in India Statue, beautification of Raipur Airport).
2. **Public Infrastructure Developed Under CSR**
 - o Roads, parks, water fountains, schools, hospitals, and other CSR-funded public spaces displaying corporate names/logos.
 - o Example: Landscaping and beautification projects with company branding.
3. **Community Development Initiatives**
 - o Sites where CSR efforts such as health check-ups, old-age homes, or skill training centers are publicly displayed.
 - o Example: Chitvan Old Age Home, Real Skill Academy.

B. Secondary Data: CSR Reports and Media Coverage

1. **CSR Reports & Disclosures**
 - o Analysis of **company CSR reports** to cross-check how CSR funds are communicated.
 - o Example: Comparing **corporate CSR claims with actual public displays**.
2. **News Articles & Press Releases**
 - o Reviewing **media coverage of CSR projects** in Raipur to assess public reception.
3. **Social Media & Digital Presence**
 - o Examining **corporate social media pages** for CSR communication trends.

Research Limitations

1. Limited Direct Public Perception Data – Since the study is based on visual CSR communication, it does not include direct feedback from citizens.
2. Dependence on Available CSR Branding – Only publicly displayed CSR communication is analyzed, which may not capture internal CSR activities.
3. Possible Corporate Bias in Messaging – Hoardings and branding elements may present CSR in an overly positive light, lacking critical perspectives.

Data Analysis

CSR communication strategies observed in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, based on the photographic and documented evidence of CSR hoardings, public displays, and branding initiatives included in the provided dataset. The research focuses on how companies communicate their CSR efforts in public spaces and how these efforts contribute to public awareness and stakeholder engagement. Given that this study is qualitative in nature, the analysis follows a thematic and visual content analysis approach, examining the language, imagery, corporate presence, and overall impact of CSR communication in Raipur.

Observations from CSR Hoardings and Public Displays in Raipur

The CSR communication materials examined include hoardings, billboards, CSR-funded infrastructure branding, and public signage. The analysis focuses on:

- Thematic categorization of CSR messaging
- Visual and textual content used in CSR communication
- Branding elements and corporate presence
- Effectiveness in raising public awareness

A. Language and Messaging Patterns in CSR Hoardings

A textual analysis of the CSR hoardings reveals the following key patterns in messaging:

Message Type	Observations
Corporate-led CSR Statements	Majority of hoardings use company-driven language, where the focus is on corporate identity rather than community engagement.
Slogan-Based Awareness Messaging	Some hoardings use short, powerful slogans, aiming to increase public awareness of CSR efforts.
Government-Corporate Collaboration	Several CSR displays highlight joint initiatives between private companies and government bodies.

B. Visual Elements and Corporate Branding in CSR Displays

The visual aspects of CSR communication materials reveal strong corporate branding elements, often overpowering the social messaging. The observed patterns include:

Visual Element	Analysis	Example from Data
Prominent Corporate Logos	Almost all CSR hoardings prominently feature company logos, often larger than the actual CSR message.	Infrastructure branding with company logos occupying significant space.
Smiling Beneficiaries	Images of students, healthcare workers, or villagers are frequently used to humanize CSR initiatives.	School branding featuring children with books, corporate banners in the background.
Environmental Imagery	CSR campaigns related to sustainability and urban beautification commonly use greenery, clean roads, and trees.	Roadside CSR hoardings for Clean Raipur Project.

Thematic Analysis of CSR Communication in Raipur

From the provided CSR communication data, three primary themes emerge in the CSR messaging across Raipur:

A. Corporate-Driven CSR Communication

- The majority of CSR hoardings focus on corporate identity, reinforcing the company's role in funding CSR initiatives rather than promoting community participation.
- Example: CSR billboards for hospital donations, school sponsorships, and infrastructure development, where the corporate branding dominates the social message.
- Impact: Ensures corporate visibility, but public engagement remains limited.

B. Public Welfare-Oriented CSR Communication

- Some hoardings prioritize community needs, focusing on healthcare, education, and environmental awareness.
- Example: CSR banners promoting free medical check-up camps, scholarship programs, and tree plantation drives.
- Impact: These campaigns have a higher social appeal, but corporate visibility remains strongly embedded in the messaging.

C. Policy-Oriented CSR Communication

- Certain CSR initiatives highlight collaborations with local government, positioning CSR as a joint effort between the private and public sectors.
- Example: CSR-supported road safety campaigns, sanitation initiatives, and Smart City projects.
- Impact: Enhances corporate credibility and ensures policy alignment, but public participation remains passive.

Comparative Assessment of CSR Communication Strategies

The effectiveness of different CSR communication strategies observed in Raipur is evaluated based on visibility, public engagement, and messaging clarity.

CSR Communication Method	Observations	Effectiveness
Large Hoardings & Billboards	High visibility, but heavily corporate-branded.	Moderate (Good reach, limited engagement).
CSR Branding on Infrastructure	Corporate presence is strong, but public engagement is minimal.	Moderate (Seen, but not interactive).
Event-Based CSR Communication	Health camps, skill training programs, high interaction potential.	High (Community participation, but short-term impact).
CSR Campaigns with Government Collaboration	Enhances credibility, but lacks public feedback mechanisms.	Moderate (Perceived as corporate PR).

Key Findings from Data Analysis

The analysis of **CSR hoardings, banners, and branding elements in Raipur** reveals the following key findings:

1. CSR communication is heavily corporate-driven. The majority of public CSR messaging is structured around corporate identity rather than interactive community awareness.
2. Public engagement mechanisms in CSR communication are limited. CSR hoardings are static and one-directional, providing information but no interactive elements such as QR codes, helplines, or community feedback options.
3. CSR communication varies by industry. Steel and manufacturing companies focus on infrastructure-based CSR, while service-sector companies prioritize skill development and education.
4. Government-private collaborations are common but lack grassroots engagement. Many CSR hoardings mention government partnerships, but these initiatives lack community-driven participation models.

Data Annexure

Godawari Power and Ispat Limited (Hira Group)

Raipur City and its Peripherals have attractive landscaped gardens and infrastructure that impresses the general public or the infrastructure is visible in all directions of the city and has Hira Group's branding on it. Hira Group aspires to address social concerns and work to benefit the local communities. As a constructive partner in the communities in which operate, Hira group has been taking concrete actions to realize social responsibility, thereby building value for shareholders and customers. Hira group supported innumerable social and community initiatives in India. Besides focusing primarily on the welfare of economically and socially deprived sections of society, Hira group is also aiming at developing technoeconomically viable and environment-friendly products & services for the benefit of all.

Make In India Statue at Telibandha Square

This contains the explicit decision-making by the Godawari Power and Ispat Limited management about the brand's basic orientation, with the company's vision and mission as integral components. Descriptive and evaluative features are: whether and to what extent the brand positioning comprehensively includes CSR, whether this results from altruistic motives in top management, whether the brand positioning is infrastructural of New India Vision of Make in India Initiative, whether this is evaluated as relevant and actively put into practice by Hira Group management, as well as whether there is potential for a better fit between the positioning and actual business activities.

Water fountain, and garden at Grand Trunk Road

A water fountain has been built by Heera Group near Anupam Garden on GT Road, a major road in Raipur, which can be seen in the picture. This water fountain not only enhances the beauty of Raipur but also builds a garden in the surroundings. It has been done by this construction, the vacant land adjacent to the road was easily utilized and at the same time the work of enhancing the beauty was done, there is the movement of people in this garden and the eyes of passers-by passing through the adjacent main road are also attracted to this water park. Almost falls on the fountain. The infrastructure of Raipur city built by Heera Group, which has been made for an abundance of beauty, is very impressive.

Health checkup organized by Godawari Power & Ispat Ltd.

Heera Group organizes health check-ups from time to time, in which the news of these health check-ups comes in local newspapers, on television, as well as through press releases, efforts are made to reach the media and through the media to the general public. As well as Heera Group's social media accounts, these efforts, which approach the multipurpose weight of CSR, are communicated through the Internet.

GK TMT

GK TMT had taken a few steps through the establishment of a trust “Real Care Foundation”, in which issues like Education, Medical Care, Environment, Sanitation, Women Empowerment, Social Upliftment of Backward Sections of the Society, and provision of Clean Drinking Water are a priority. Such initiatives give us psychological pride in working towards the vision of the State and Central government. Some of the contributions are:

Beautification work near Raipur International Airport

Near Raipur International Airport GK TMT is doing development and maintenance work on the garden and landscape near the airport road as well as the landscape garden developed by GK TMT has displayed its brand logo. The departing passengers are noticed at a primary level and thus GK TMT can convey its gratitude to a large section of passengers traveling by air.

Chitvan Old Age Home

With the establishment of an old age home, the GK group is taking significant steps toward filling the void of such homes. It gives us true satisfaction in providing senior citizens with all the prerequisites of a basic lifestyle with proper medical and social care. Books, gardening, family dinners, and a unified atmosphere coupled with regular park visits and occasional outings to movie theatres, etc. makes them feel one with society once again.

Real Skill Academy

Real Skill Academy is a vocational training center to provide free training to around 500 people annually in about 12 villages and helps them in job placement thereafter.

Vrindavan Auditorium and Library

A high-capacity seminar hall equipped with state-of-the-art audiovisual equipment and facilities is leveraged daily by various social organizations almost free of cost and is considered an absolute gift to society. A library in the heart of the city is an additional contribution to our concern for education.

Primary and Middle School

A government school in Kara village was renovated and turned into a model school with all the modern amenities and facilities like classrooms, a library, a badminton court, waterproofing, etc for all the students from the nearby villages.

Scholarship Program

Every year poor students from more than 10 villages who are wanting to get a quality education are given scholarships by the company. Additionally, notebook bags and stationery materials are provided to more than 200–250 schools in Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh for supporting the educational needs of thousands of students.

Medical Care

To cater to the medical needs of underprivileged people, every year the company sponsors critical medical care where major operations are required. For providing quick medical care, an ambulance service is also being run for various villages. Recently, a mega medical camp was organized where thousands of beneficiaries went through a medical checkup free of cost. The development of a proper approach towards local lakes is some other examples of work that Gk group been doing.

Infrastructure & Social Upliftment

We are dedicated to the development of nearby villages by contributing and assisting in the construction and maintenance of schools, parks, hospitals, temples, Mukti Dham, community halls, etc. We are also working towards their beautification through plantation and “total sanitation” in these areas which are in line with the Prime Minister’s vision of “Swachh Bharat Abhiyan”. We have also contributed and helped towards the transformation of these villages into Nirmal Gram. We have shown significant interest in the growth and development of kids in these areas by conducting various computer-training programs

and organizing various competitions in schools that contribute towards their overall personality development.

Blue Lines TMT & Pipes

Police Barricading

Police Barricading with Blue TMT & Pipes brand near Raipur International Airport.

RAMA TMT

Beautification work near Raipur International Airport

Gardening and landscape work has been done on a large scale near Raipur International Airport by Rama TMT, which is being maintained very well. For the passengers coming from the airport and people passing through the Naya Raipur area, this garden and landscape, which is built by Rama TMT, appears to be the center of attraction at first sight, and also the attractive logo of the Rama TMT brand is undoubtedly visible at the primary level. The area where this work has been done under the brand name of Rama TMT at this time, due to the absence of overcrowding, looks completely different and seems to be remembered for a long time.

GOEL TMT

“Giving Back to the Society, That Provided for Us”²

“All these steps help us to ensure that we are moving towards the sustainable growth of our group and its ecosystem.”³

The two quotations above are taken from the CSR branch of the official website of Goyal TMT, from which it appears that Goyal TMT is not only working through CSR in the city and peripherals but also doing image-building work on a large scale systematically. Goyal TMT seems to be quite successful in projecting itself at the primary level with its bright red colored people and well-furnished and well-placed extensive branding and creation of large landscaped gardens.

Statue at Raipur International Airport

A huge statue of Chhattisgarhi's folk art is very close to Raipur airport as well as developed and maintained in a large area. Along with this, the brand logo of Goyal TMT is placed in the middle of the dividers for several kilometers, which is in the middle of the gardening of the dividers being maintained by Goyal TMT, which gives the impression of a different image building towards Goyal TMT.

Goyal TMT Brand Pillars

The picture displayed in the figure is taken near Raipur International Airport. As soon as you leave the airport, this bright red branding of Goyal TMT is continuously visible. While coming towards the airport, they are displayed at a long distance from the divider installed by Goyal TMT. Raipur Airport has installed these pillars of Goyal TMT's brand in the middle of the road at a short distance, on reaching from any direction. This pillar which is spread over many kilometers is unforgettable.

Ambulance, School, And Community Hall

Goyal TMT has undertaken necessary measures to aid the lesser privileged. initiatives include the donation of an ambulance to the MGM Eye Hospital and building a community hall in the village of Bendri and a school in Sarora & Bendri.

Manorama

CSR From Manorama To AIIMS for Covid-19

Manorama Industries Limited extend its support to All India Institute of Medical Sciences Raipur (AIIMS) and gifts to AIIMS equipment on June 8th, 2020. In the picture is Dr. Nagarkar Director AIIMS, Dr. Sarita Agarwal HOD AIIMS, from Manorama Dr. Neeta Kanwar, Vinita Saraf, and Ashish Saraf.

Initiatives of companies in Raipur to promote brand image with the help of corporate social responsibility

CSR is not new to Chhattisgarh; many companies have been imbibing the case for social good in their operations for decades long before CSR become a popular cause. In spite of having such life-size successful examples, CSR in India is in a very nascent stage. But the situation is changing. And CSR is coming out of the purview of “doing social good” and is fast becoming a business necessity. The “business case” for CSR is gaining ground and corporate houses are realizing that “what is good for workers—their community, health, and environment is also good for the businesses. In this context, let us look at the top CSR social initiatives projects in Chhattisgarh.

Muskan Initiative by Himalaya Drug Company

The Himalaya Drug Company rolled out its flagship initiative ‘Muskan’ in Chhattisgarh in October 2020. The initiative aims to spread awareness about cleft lip and palate conditions. In partnership with Smile Train, the world’s leading cleft organization, the initiative will support free life-saving cleft treatment for children in need. Through the campaign, Ek Nayi Muskaan, Himalaya Lip Care will focus on spreading awareness around cleft lip and palate treatment at the grassroots level. As part of the initiative, a multimedia awareness campaign has started reaching out to people across Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh. Smile Train India’s toll-free Cleft Helpline, 1800-103-8301, is available for people to enquire about cleft and avail of free cleft treatment.

Waste to Health Program by Vedanta

Vedanta Aluminium & Power Business is fostering hundreds of MSMEs in remote rural areas with its ‘waste to wealth’ programs. Waste-to-wealth projects form a key pillar of Vedanta’s sustainability agenda that is centered around “Zero Harm, Zero Waste and Zero Discharge. In the Korba district of Chhattisgarh, the company is running a program whereby it is fostering local micro-enterprises in fly-ash brickmaking. The company supports over a hundred brick-manufacturing MSMEs situated around and beyond its areas of operations with fly ash and transporting it free of cost to their doorsteps, amounting to nearly 5 lakh metric tonnes per annum. In addition, the company also provides the know-how and training on manufacturing these bricks in partnership with technical institutes, thus creating employment avenues as well as promoting a circular economy.

The beneficiaries of this project are underprivileged villagers who would otherwise depend on cattle rearing, and subsistence agriculture or would migrate to other states to work as construction laborers for their livelihood.

HDFC Bank and AROH Foundation’s efforts to double farmer’s incomes in Chhattisgarh

Kabirdham district is one of the smallest districts of Chhattisgarh. The district is endowed with a beautiful landscape, rivers and springs, and ample forest cover. It is a tribal district of simple and hardworking people. The majority of the population in the Kabirdham district is engaged in agriculture for their livelihood. Presence of adequate agricultural land and an abundance of water bodies, agriculture has been the most convenient option for subsistence by the people.

While the availability of agricultural resources is aplenty in the region, challenges like inadequate training or lack of information about better and advanced agriculture practices among farmers, poor awareness regarding effective control of various pests (insects, diseases, and weeds), unavailability of quality manure, seeds or tools, insufficient & mismanaged irrigation resources, lack of agro-processing units & lack of extension services, etc. are overpowering the hard struggle the farmers were putting in, resulting into insufficient yield and income, to help these farmers, AROH Foundation, in partnership with the HDFC Bank, has been implementing Holistic Rural Development Projects (HRDP) in over 39 remotest villages in Chhattisgarh.

With a panel of experts pre-assessing the challenges, opportunities, and mitigation strategy, the main focus of the program is on food security and doubling the farmer’s income through capacity building for resource optimization, diversification in crops, agricultural practices, local solution-based models promotion for better income opportunities for villagers, incubating and scaling of agriculture and allied micro-enterprises with backward and forward linkages support.

The project will promote Farmer's Producer Groups and link them with potential enterprises, SHGs & JLGs, etc. for a better support system and convergence with government schemes. The project is expected to benefit a population of 10,650 people engaged in farming on 5750 acres of agricultural land.

Digital Classroom Project by Microsoft India

To fill the persisting digital gap among the students of rural government primary schools of Chhattisgarh and help empower illiterate adults with the gift of literacy, Humana People to People India has joined hands with Rajiv Gandhi Shiksha Mission, Govt. of Chhattisgarh and Microsoft to launch the Digital Learning Programme in 16 schools of Raigarh and Mungeli districts of the state. The Programme is delivered under two broad verticals: School Learning and Adult Literacy.

Under its school learning component, the Programme provides a technology-enabled learning environment to primary school students of grades 1–5 of 16 schools—eight from each district—in the two selected districts. The Digital Learning Programme aims to enhance the learning levels of the students through the strategic use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT), while simultaneously developing their critical thinking and creativity. Under the Programme, computer labs are developed in each school and the capacity of the teachers is built to inculcate new methods to teach subjects with the help of multimedia content. Video-based learning is promoted through a “School-in-box” solution comprising a projection system and speakers to keep the students actively engaged in the learning process, while the assessment is conducted through a digital “Learning Management System”. The video content has been developed by expert content creators and is structured in line with the age/grades of the children. The adult literacy component of the Programme aims to promote and enhance functional literacy among the illiterate adults of both districts. This computer-based approach to adult literacy caters to the 3Rs of reading, writing, and arithmetic. Enhanced functional literacy among adults is expected to reflect in their increased participation in government programs while also promoting the participation of women in household income generation.

South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL)

South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL) is one of the largest Coal Producing subsidiaries of Coal India Limited (CIL), a Maharatna Company. In continuation of its support for Shramiks, on 05.06.2020, SECL distributed 3000 food packets & water bottles to Shramikstraveling by Amritsar-Champa (No. 04602) & Raipur-Basti (No. 08741) Special Trains, at Bilaspur Station. The activity was taken under the SECL CSR initiative.

CSR Campaigns Designs

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) is about a company's efforts being made in a socially responsible manner. From the research to the final product, from the company's workforce to society, everyone aims to make a positive impact around the world, at the same time, these efforts reduce the effect of negativity towards corporates, due to which the local law and order that occurs spontaneously remain systematic. Working to address social concerns and benefiting local communities, corporates are working intensively till the peripherals of Raipur city realize their social responsibility, as a constructive partner in them. Due to this value is being created for the shareholders and customers of these companies. These companies have supported several social and community initiatives. , Apart from primarily focusing on the welfare of the economically and socially disadvantaged sections of society, it also undertakes to develop techno-economically viable and eco-friendly products and services for the benefit of all.

Relief to relieve

1. Financial Aid to Bihar Flood Relief Fund, arranged relief camps, lifesaving boats, and jackets in rescue operations.
2. Financial aid to Chief Minister's Relief Fund.
3. Different household articles are gifted to newly wedded couples to help them in their new beginning.

4. Helped by providing Diesel Generator sets in Bastar to recover the region from Naxalite Black-out.

Educating life

Developing PPP (Public Private Partnerships)

1. Various PPPs with Govt. of India has been formed to provide a new world of opportunity in technical education.
2. Electrification & construction of additional classrooms of different Govt. Schools.
3. Construction of boundary walls for various Govt. Primary Schools.
4. Donations to under-developed
5. Financial aid to AKANSHA (School for Mentally Challenged Children) to help them in establish mainstream.
6. Financial aid to MGM Eye Institute for their various eye-based Research and development.
7. Financial fund for the education of 100 children, scheme known as UDAAN to promote CHILD EDUCATION.
8. Financial support for Chhattisgarh Mahila Kosh under” Duttak Putri Siksha Yojna” to inspire education among underprivileged girls.

Training & Reward

1. Corporate Groups from Raipur have taken various direct initiatives for technical and soft skill training and development of youth by organizing training camps, workshops, and seminars.
2. Provided training and stipend to many ITI Candidates, mainly for various rural parts of India to enhance technical education in the remote region.
3. Distributed various gifts to various meritorious students of Govt. Primary and Middle School to boost their morale and enthusiasm towards education.

Teaching Support

1. Sponsoring teachers’ salaries in rural areas to make up for the deficiency of quality education.
2. Installation of computers and donated furniture to various schools’ basic facilities should reach every school in the rural part.

Alignment For Better Development

1. MOU with leading techno houses for placement and exchange of faculties.
2. MOU with the educational group for placement and exchange of faculties.

Developing Infrastructure

1. Maintenance of rural roads, arrangement of safe drinking water, donated computer systems.
2. Contribution to Gram Vikas Samiti for developing rural road drains and installing street lights.
3. Provided instant Power Support during a power crisis in Central India.
4. Constructed Borewells in rural areas to cover water crises.
5. Provided water coolers to various administrative offices in central India.
6. Construction of concrete gate arches in different locations in Central India.
7. Provided Blankets and Utensils.
8. Various community upliftment activities such as the construction of the Ram Lila Stage, Festival Celebrations, approach roads, etc. in rural areas.
9. Provided sewing machines, clothes, ceiling fans, chairs, etc. to needful communities.
10. Financial assistance to nearby rural communities for their social and cultural upliftment.

Health Camps & Campaigns

Regular and integrated medical camps with super specialist doctors from eminent hospitals have benefited as below:

1. Blood donation Camp: Organized with the help of the Red Cross Society, Central India.

2. Free Eyecheckup Camps: Organised various free eye check-up camps with the help of the District Blindness help society.
 3. Other Health Check-up Camps: Free health check-up camps for Hemoglobin, BDM Tests, Diabetes, Lung function, etc. have been organized in different communities of both urban and rural society.
 4. Pulse Polio Campaigns to contribute to India's mission of polio eradication.
- **Helping needy individuals**
 1. Financial aid to patients of chronic diseases like Cancer, Kidney Disorders.
 2. Donated Tri Cycles to make their life easier.
 3. Free medicines to various needy persons in rural areas.
 4. Helping patients by distributing bedsheets, utensils, and other needs.
 - **Valuable sponsorships**
 1. Sponsored Medical Mobile Unit (MMU) Van for Helpage.
 2. Weekly Deployment of doctors and free medicines distribution with MMU Van to promote health awareness in rural.
 3. Financial assistance to Gram Panchayat to purchase Ambulance.
 - **First-Aid Center**
 1. First-aid health center and deputed qualified doctors to enhance medical facilities in rural areas.
 2. Rural health awareness campaigns.
 3. Organised Nukkad Natak for Nasha Mukti.

Recommendations

Based on the findings, the following recommendations can improve CSR communication effectiveness in Raipur:

1. Shift CSR messaging focus from corporate branding to social impact.
2. Introduce interactive elements (QR codes, helpline numbers) on hoardings for community feedback.
3. Encourage two-way communication by integrating social media campaigns with offline CSR displays.
4. Ensure messaging clarity by prioritizing beneficiary-driven storytelling rather than corporate slogans.
5. Incorporate regional languages in CSR hoardings to improve accessibility and inclusivity.

The data analysis of CSR communication materials in Raipur highlights a corporate-centric approach to public CSR messaging with a strong emphasis on branding over community participation. While CSR initiatives cover education, healthcare, and environmental awareness, the visual representation focuses more on corporate identity than fostering public dialogue.

For CSR communication to be more impactful, companies need to adopt a participatory approach, ensuring that CSR messages are accessible, interactive, and community-driven.

Conclusion

Sustainable business growth is associated with care for the community and markets the corporations operate. Companies are involved in CSR in business practices and customers today almost expect companies to be socially responsible. CSR does not give immediate results. The same CSR initiative will also not work for all types of organizations. A successful CSR initiative requires careful planning and implementation mechanism. Integrating innovative CSR strategies into different marketing communication strategies to build and sustain a competitive advantage. Thus, CSR becoming a fast-developing and increasingly competitive field, and the case for demonstrating corporate responsibility is getting stronger as expectations among key opinion formers, customers, and the public are increasing.

This research has described that referring to the mandatory approach to the public relation of CSR, primarily aims to gain social welfare, and is important for building the brand image of the organization. The research also confirms that most organizations in Raipur City assume public relations officers as the person in charge to deal with CSR. Therefore, CSR can be said as a communication tool to gain a reputation.

Therefore, after having an overview of the above, it can be said that companies and business people who wish to thrive long-term must adopt sound ethical decision-making practices. To achieve a competitive advantage in terms of economic, social, financial, and environmental aspects there is a solid need for integration between CSR and branding.

1.Source: <https://www.thegivingmachine.co.uk/blog/posts/corporate-social-responsibility-a-simple-guide/>

2.<https://www.goelpipes.com/csr>

3.<https://www.goelpipes.com/csr>

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